WILLY (WEI-LI) CHEN

Old Botany Rm 5, Michigan State University | East Lansing, MI
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EDUCATION

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI *August 2022 – Present*
Doctor of Philosophy - Economics
- Fields: Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics
- ICER NASA Open Scholarship Fellow *Fall 2026*
- Summer Research Fellowship *Summer 2026*
- Peter Schmidt [Outstanding First-Year Student] Award *Summer 2023*

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL *October 2019 – August 2020*
Master of Arts in Social Sciences—Economics
- Phoenix Research Award
- Director's Scholarship

The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH *August 2015 – May 2019*
Bachelor of Science in Mathematics—Theoretical
Bachelor of Science in Economics—Summa Cum Laude with Research Distinction

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Data Analytics and Econometrics: Stata, R, Python, PostgreSQL, LaTeX, Large Language Model training, SLURM high performance computing workflow
- Languages: Fluent in English, Taiwanese, and Taiwanese Mandarin

JOB MARKET PAPER

Discounted Degrees: Employer Frictions and the Misallocation of High-Skilled Immigrants

PEER-REVIEWED PAPERS

Elbel, B., Zhou, G. E., Lee, D. C., Chen, W., Day, S. E., Konty, K. J., & Schwartz, A. E. (2022). *Analysis of School-Level Vaccination Rates by Race, Ethnicity, and Geography in New York City.* JAMA network open, 5(9), e2231849-e2231849.

WORKING PAPERS

Chen, Willy and Qiao, Xiao and Zhang, Hanzhe, Over a Century of Economics Research Collaboration (May 21, 2025). Available at SSRN: https://ssrn.com/abstract=5263564 or http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5263564

Toossi, Saied and Schwartz, Amy Ellen and Chen, Willy, The Relationship between Entrée Variety and Student Participation in School Lunch (August 01, 2025). Available at SSRN: https://ssrn.com/abstract=5378789 or http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5378789

Chen, Willy, (Resubmitted to Social Choice and Welfare) Descriptive Units of Heterogeneity: An Axiomatic Approach to Measuring Heterogeneity (July 23, 2024). Available at SSRN: https://ssrn.com/abstract=4952556 or http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4952556

WORK IN PROGRESS

Understanding Immigrant Occupational Mismatch: The Role of Intra-Household Bargaining and Employer-Sponsored Health Insurance (with Elif Dilden)

Talent Reallocation Amid Silicon Valley Tech Layoffs (with Hannah Bae and Xintong Li)

Open-Source Job-Title Classifier: a public version of the LLM-based occupation coder from my job market paper, supported by the ICER NASA Open Science Scholars Fellowship

PRESENTATIONS

Discounted Degrees: Employer Frictions and the Misallocation of High-Skilled Immigrants
- WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference, St. Louis, MO — *October 2026*
- Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL — *March 2026*

Descriptive Units of Heterogeneity: An Axiomatic Approach to Measuring Heterogeneity
- Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO — *March 2025*

Over a Century of Economics Research Collaboration (with X. Qiao and H. Zhang)
- ASSA Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA (presented by co-author) — *January 2025*
- Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL (earlier version) — *March 2024*

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI — *August 2022 – Present*

- ***Economics Course Instructor :***
  - EC201—Introduction to Microeconomics—Spartan Early Start Session, Summer '25
- ***Economics Courses Teaching Assistant:***
  - EC251H/EC301—Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall '22, '24, '25; Spring '26)
  - EC812B—PhD Game Theory (Spring '24, '25, '26)
- *Teaching materials* (recitation handouts, R workshop): willycecon.com/teaching
- ***Economics Graduate Research Assistant:***
  - Hanzhe Zhang (Fall '23; Summer '24)
- ***MSU Sailing Center***
  - Lead ('26) and Assistant ('25) Small Boat Sailing Instructor (Summer '25, '26)

Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY — *September 2020 – May 2022*
Research Associate, Center for Policy Research

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL — *September 2019 – June 2020*
Teaching Assistant, ECON 100/200/201
Instructor, Online Workshop: Principles of Data Visualization in R (MAPSS), 2020

SERVICES

- Director of Event Planning, MSU Council of Graduate Students — *May 2025 - Present*
- Social Chair, Department of Economics — *August 2023 - Aug 2024*

REFERENCES

Todd Elder (Dissertation Co-Chair) telder@msu.edu
Title: MSU Foundation Professor of Economics, Michigan State University

Hanzhe Zhang (Dissertation Co-Chair) hanzhe@msu.edu
Title: Mark A. Simon Distinguished Associate Professor of Economics, Michigan State University

Stephen Woodbury (Dissertation Committee Member) woodbur2@msu.edu
Title: Professor of Economics, Michigan State University